



MONTHLY UPDATE

Morocco: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-20 · 38 systems and instruments tracked, 17 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-20 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Police patrol vehicles carrying live facial recognition entered field service in Rabat in the week of 20 July 2026, with Casablanca and Tangier announced next ([deployment account](#)). Neither held account cites a data-protection authorisation, a retention rule or an oversight mechanism for them.

The month's other movements were commitments rather than deliveries. A memorandum with a data-centre equipment supplier was signed on 27 July with no sum attached ([ministry communique](#)), a 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July ([bill account](#)), and the ministry named entry into force of a US\$250m programme before 23 September as its immediate priority ([ministry account](#)).

The ombudsman's 2025 report, presented on 23 July, recorded 9,958 files opened and a mean 815 days to implement a recommendation ([report account](#)).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

An operator and a vendor placed a dual-band radio configuration into commercial service along the high-speed rail and motorway corridors on 30 July 2026, claiming a 13 dB coverage gain, 83% higher average downlink throughput and 3.2 times the active users with no additional sites built ([deployment account](#)). Every performance figure is the operator's and the vendor's own.

The transitional reduction of mobile interconnection tariff asymmetry took effect on 1 July 2026, running to 31 January 2027, with full symmetry from 1 February 2027, recorded in the incumbent's own half-year filing ([operator filing](#)).

The vendor has since put figures on it: [roughly a kilometre of extra range, an 83% download-speed gain and 3.2 times more concurrent users per site](#), against a regulator count of 19.4m mobile subscriptions and a 34.04% share for the operator at the end of March. The performance gains are the vendor's own.

Data Storage

The ministry signed a memorandum of understanding with a data-centre power and cooling supplier in Rabat on 27 July, covering digital infrastructure, cloud, artificial intelligence, high-performance computing and data centres. The ministry's own text commits only to exchanged expertise, technical studies and the identification of structuring projects, and attaches no sum; the 50 MW sovereign data centre in Rabat is named as something the cooperation will feed ([ministry communicate](#)). Parallel talks were held the same day with two other suppliers on the same ground.

The Dakhla campus acquired a shape without acquiring a date. It is [planned as a green data-centre campus under the Igoudar Numerique programme, one part for the kingdom's sovereign digital needs and another open to private investment, with feasibility studies launched in April 2026](#). No capacity, cost, operator or commissioning date is held for it, and the same account gives no national facility count that would place it in an estate.

The compute platform behind that estate acquired a price. A press account citing third-party analysis [puts the Casablanca project at roughly US\\$1.2bn and up to 500MW, naming a South Korean cloud operator, a chip maker and the platform's developer, with a second renewable-powered project planned for Dakhla](#). Neither figure comes from a filing, and the question the same account raises is whether hosting foreign-operated infrastructure builds anything domestic beyond the hosting.

Cybersecurity

The [national cybersecurity strategy to 2030 is now held in full: four pillars — governance, cyberspace resilience, capacity development and regional cooperation — with 11 objectives, 26 initiatives and 60 actions, succeeding the first strategy of 2012](#). Its workforce commitments carry no numbers, and [a separate held source dates a national cybersecurity strategy to 2023 with US\\$100m earmarked and an agency created](#) — whether the two are the same instrument is not established.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

A national water digital twin was described publicly on 28 July, to rest on a sovereign national data platform hosted in Morocco and fuse sensor networks, satellite observation and data from the basin agencies, the planning commission and engineering consultancies. The project lead put a first pilot 18 to 24 months away and gave no cost, budget line or procurement route ([project account](#)).

A platform already carrying national data went under inspection instead. The health ministry [put its national health-data platform through a security and performance audit running from July to September, covering infrastructure, application, database and cybersecurity on a 170,000 dirham budget](#), with no cyberattack or breach cited as the trigger. No findings are published.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The government council approved a draft decree on 9 July 2026 amending the 2008 biometric passport decree: four languages including Amazigh, an encrypted chip to international civil aviation standard, the holder's address removed from the biodata page and temporary passports abolished ([approval account](#)). Issuance is expected from August 2026, and the joint body that will set issuance procedures is not yet in place.

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

The same 50-article digital health bill adopted in the government council on 22 July 2026 creates a shared medical record and a national health identifier under a new digitisation agency ([bill account](#)).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

An interior ministry circular reported on 25 July abolished 22 administrative certificates and replaced them with sworn declarations, on the ministry's finding that citizens had routinely been made to produce them with no legal basis, and confirmed that only procedures published on the national portal are legally enforceable ([circular account](#)).

Switzerland's economic secretariat, the World Bank Group and a Swiss innovation body launched a public-audit innovation challenge in Rabat on 22 July with the general finance inspectorate and the court of audit as institutional users; no budget, award size or timetable was announced ([launch account](#)).

The ombudsman's 2025 annual report, presented on 23 July, gives the counterpoint: 9,958 files opened, up more than 25% year on year, 1,653 settlement decisions, and a mean 815 days to implement a recommendation and 774 days to close a file ending in one ([report account](#)). The institution holds that several administrations moved existing steps onto platforms without reworking the underlying process, and attributes repeated demands for the same documents to weak interconnection of administrative databases ([commentary](#)).

One portal went the other way. The Court of Cassation's site [has been down for more than a week with no official explanation](#), on a bar-association lawyer's account, at a point where the courts increasingly expect rulings to be tracked online. No court or ministry statement is held.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

A 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July 2026, creating a national health identifier and a shared medical record under a new digitisation agency, with implementing decrees due within 12 months of publication and provider connection within 24 months of the technical decree ([bill account](#)). [Unlawful consultation, use or exchange of personal health data would draw six months to a year and MAD 50,000-200,000](#).

A constitutional-law academic stated on 30 July that the revised electoral framework criminalises use of artificial intelligence to distort the truth or intrude on the private lives of candidates and voters, naming no law, article number or gazette reference ([commentary](#)).

The data-protection statute is being recast rather than replaced. The regulator's president stated on the record that a recast of law 09-08, developed with the justice ministry, has entered the legislative circuit and been sent to the secretariat general of the government; he describes it as clarification rather than replacement. The [law itself has been in force since 2009](#), and no transmission date or text for the recast is held.

Strategies, plans and policies

Digital Morocco 2030 is in force with a [US\\$250m acceleration programme attached in June](#), against a [technology sector at 6.8% of gross domestic product on a 2025 figure](#). Two held sources give its 2030 jobs target as 150,000 and as 240,000, and neither reconciles with the other.

Regional collaboration

Morocco was elected to the African Telecommunications Union's Administrative Council for 2027-2031 at the union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja on 25 July, with a delegation combining the digital ministry, the regulator and the development agency ([ministry communique](#)).

Data protection

Live facial recognition entered service in Rabat in the same weeks ([deployment account](#)), presented by the police directorate as domestically engineered and reported with an up-to-95% plate-recognition figure ([second account](#)).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Simplification is law and is not yet practice. A member's written question to the digital transition ministry put the ombudsman's 2025 finding on the record: [agencies still ask citizens for paper copies of documents the administration already holds electronically, and impose undisclosed extra conditions](#), which is what the procedural simplification law was passed to stop. No ministry answer is held. The complaint from the other end is about coverage rather than paperwork: residents of one Sefrou commune [are asking for new or strengthened transmission stations, describing reliable connectivity as a condition of schooling, work and emergency access](#).

EU activities

Morocco holds [no European Union adequacy decision: the Commission's list names sixteen jurisdictions plus one international organisation, none of them in Africa](#). Neither source establishing this is tagged to Morocco, and no Morocco-tagged governance source the base holds mentions the European Union at all.

Open data

The open-data portal is operating with four published procedure volumes — [manuals for open-data officers and data managers](#), a [data-inventory methodology](#) and a [standards and formats manual](#) — and published datasets including a [1,028-entry start-up database](#). A steering committee of ten bodies was established in December 2019 and a readiness assessment carried out in 2020, whose report remains unheld. The portal's own dataset count, publication statistics and action plan are not held either.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

The one artificial-intelligence figure to move in the window is a ranking rather than a capability. Morocco is placed [87th globally and eighth in the MENA region on an index of government readiness for artificial intelligence, up fourteen places in 2025](#), which the account attributes to the AI Made in Morocco roadmap and a regional data-for-sustainable-development hub developed with UNDP. The index itself is not named in the record held, so the starting position is derived from the reported change rather than published directly — and neither the roadmap's own founding text nor any progress report against Digital Morocco 2030 is held.

The institutional side did move. Four public-interest institutes [were established by publication in the Official Gazette, covering artificial-intelligence research and sovereign systems, education, industrial automation and smart cities](#), under the national digital and artificial-intelligence strategies. No budget, staffing or opening date is stated for any of them.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

An operator's sustainability report published on 10 July recorded 6,000 internet boxes refurbished in Morocco during 2025, which the operator put at about EUR 1.5m in savings, within a regional programme that refurbished 164,000 boxes in 2025, up 43% on 2024 ([operator report](#)). The figures are the operator's own and unaudited in the held source.

Training and skills

The ministry signed a memorandum with a consultancy in Rabat on 17 July 2026 covering artificial-intelligence skills-building across administrations, universities and research centres, support to institute-backed start-ups and public-service use cases, with no value, term, headcount target or delivery milestone disclosed ([memorandum account](#)).

Finance

New investments

The ministry stated on 22 July that the digital transformation acceleration programme, approved and signed in June 2026, is backed by US\$250m over five years, and that bringing it into force before 23 September 2026 was its immediate priority ([ministry account](#)). The programme was not in force at 6 August.

A corporate venture fund of US\$250m, writing cheques of up to US\$5m into regional start-ups, was reported operating on 2 August, the figure attributed by the reporting outlet to a third-party tracker rather than to any Moroccan disclosure ([tracker account](#)).

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